



PROJECT PROPOSAL & COSTING

Pan-African stays, visa-free travel.

A Booking.com-style marketplace for African stays, with a government-partnered Visa-Free Pass — built for African payment rails.

Prepared by

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Date

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Live prototype

iviwemalotana.github.io/afritravel

THE OPPORTUNITY

Travel within Africa is booming — but the tools aren't built for it

- **Payments don't fit.** Global platforms lean on cards; Africans pay with Mobile Money, USSD and local rails.
- **Inventory is thin.** Local stays are under-listed and priced in the wrong currencies.
- **Visas are friction.** Free-movement blocs (AfCFTA, ECOWAS, EAC, SADC) exist, but travellers don't know their rights and borders aren't digital.

The wedge

One platform that lists African stays, accepts **Paystack & Mobile Money**, and issues a **digital Visa-Free Pass** in partnership with governments — so booking a trip and crossing the border happen in one place.

54 markets

7+ currencies

Gov-partnered

THE PRODUCT

Four portals, one marketplace

Travellers

Search & book stays across Africa, pay with Paystack or Mobile Money, manage trips.

Visa-Free Pass

Register once, get an instantly-approved digital border pass with a scannable code.

Merchants

Hosts list properties, manage bookings & calendars, and receive payouts.

Admin

Platform health: inventory, transactions, KYC, fraud & compliance oversight.

Payments

Paystack (card/USSD/bank) + MTN/Airtel/M-Pesa Mobile Money, multi-currency.

Governments

Immigration partners verify passes — the rails for digital free movement.

NOT A CONCEPT — A WORKING PROTOTYPE

The product is already live today

- All four portals built and navigable
- Stay search, filtering, listing detail & live price quoting
- End-to-end booking with Paystack & Mobile Money (demo mode)
- Visa-Free Pass registration → issued digital pass with scannable code
- Built on the production stack: Vite · TypeScript · AWS-ready

Built in days, not months — de-risks the estimate below.



Try it now

iviwemalotana.github.io/afritravel

Live · public · responsive

SCOPE OF WORK

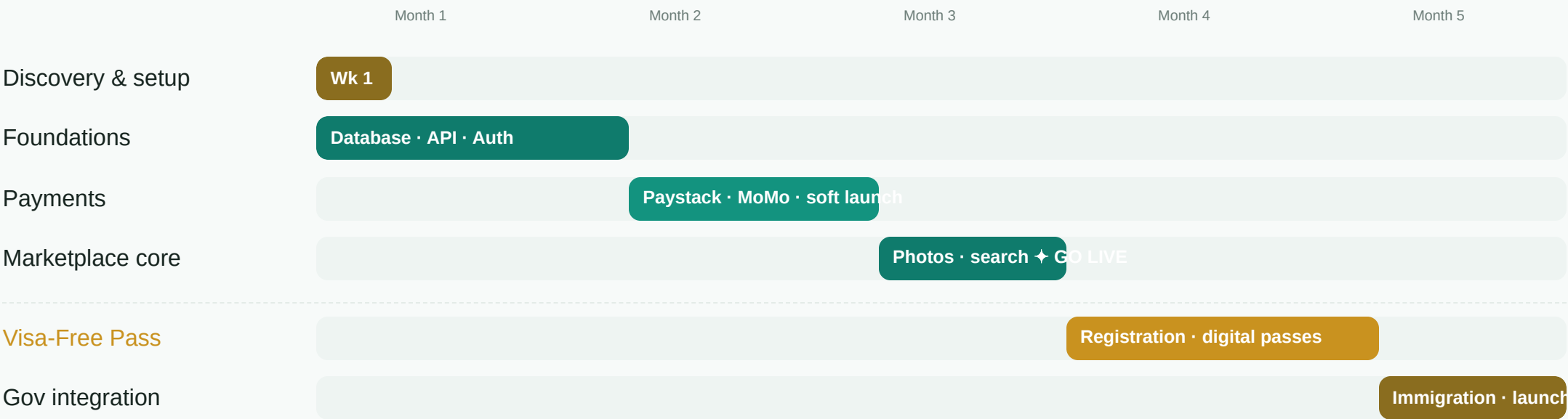
From prototype to production, in four phases

PHASE	WHAT GETS BUILT	OUTCOME
1 • Foundations	Database, API, auth (Cognito), admin CRUD, CI/CD, live data	Real accounts & live inventory
2 • Payments	Live Paystack + MoMo, webhooks, booking states, merchant payouts, receipts	Money moves · Soft launch
3 • Marketplace depth	Photos, calendars & dynamic pricing, search/maps, reviews, host onboarding + KYC	Go live & earning · Live
4 • Visa-Free Pass	Government rule engine, verifiable passes, immigration integration, trip planner	The differentiator · Visa launch

Track 1 (phases 1–3) = 3 months to live & earning. **Track 2** (phase 4) = +2 months for the Visa-Free Pass. Each phase is independently shippable.

PROPOSED TIMELINE

3 months to go live & earning · 5 to the full vision



● Month 3 — live & taking bookings. Foundations → payments → core marketplace.

● +2 months — Visa-Free Pass. Software is ~4–6 weeks; go-live is gated by government partnerships, not development.

WHO'S BUILDING IT

Iviwe Malotana

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Full-Stack AI-Enabled Developer & Product Owner · Cape Town · BSc Electrical & Computer Engineering, UCT

- **7+ years** shipping web products end-to-end — database to interface, and the product decisions in between.
- **Fintech-hardened:** built payment, billing, recurring-card & fraud-detection systems handling *live customer money*.
- **Multi-tenant SaaS** with role-based permissions, webhooks & event-driven integrations — the exact shape of AfriTravel.
- Currently building a multi-tenant AI platform (React 19 + TypeScript front end, Python on AWS).

TypeScript / React

Python · AWS Lambda

DynamoDB · Cognito

Stripe / Paddle billing

Webhooks · Event-driven

Fraud & compliance

Figma · UX/UI

CI/CD · Playwright

Build fee by track

TRACK	SCOPE	DURATION	ZAR	≈ USD
1 · Go live & earning	Foundations · payments · core marketplace	3 months	R350,000	\$18,900
2 · Visa-Free Pass	Registration · digital passes · gov integration	+2 months	R90,000	\$4,860
Total build		~5 months	R440,000	\$23,800

💡 **Go live for R350,000** (~\$18,900) in 3 months — then add the Visa-Free Pass program as a **R90,000** (~\$4,860) follow-on, funded from early revenue.

🔧 **Care plan (post-launch):** R15,000–22,000/mo (~\$810–1,190) — fixes, updates, small features, monitoring.

Fixed-fee per track, billed on milestone sign-off. Estimates; final scope confirmed at discovery. Excludes the running costs on the next slide.

Running costs (paid directly to providers)

Cloud hosting — AWS

MVP / launch traffic	\$180–320/mo
Growth (~50k bookings/mo)	\$900–1,500/mo

Payment processing (pass-through)

Paystack — local	~1.5% + small flat
Paystack — international	~3.9%
Mobile Money collections	~1–2%

Other services

Domain (.com / .africa)	\$15–40/yr
Transactional email/SMS	within AWS (~\$5–20/mo)
SSL certificate	Free (AWS ACM)
Error monitoring (optional)	~\$26/mo
Maps/geocoding (if used)	usage-based
Mobile app stores (Phase 5)	\$99/yr + \$25 once

Payment fees scale with sales (a cost of revenue), not a fixed bill. Hosting scales with traffic.
Detailed AWS breakdown in *docs/AWS_COSTS.md*.

THE NUMBERS AT A GLANCE

Total cost of ownership — year one

One-time build (full)

R440k

~\$23,800 · both tracks

Hosting · year one

~\$3k

MVP tier, scales with traffic

Care plan · year one

~R220k

~\$11,900 · optional, post-launch

Phased entry to control cash flow

Go live and take real bookings for **R350k** (Track 1, 3 months). Fund the **R90k** Visa-Free Pass track from early revenue. Payment fees only kick in once you're earning.

HOW BILLING WORKS

Milestone-based payment schedule

MILESTONE	TRIGGER	% OF PHASE
Kickoff deposit	Discovery sign-off, work begins	30%
Mid-phase review	Core features demoed	40%
Phase acceptance	Deployed & signed off	30%

✓ Each phase invoiced independently — no large upfront lock-in.

✓ Running costs (AWS, payments, domain) billed directly to the company's own accounts — full transparency, no markup.

NEXT STEPS

Let's build the rails for African travel.

- Book a discovery session to lock scope & the Phase-1 statement of work
- Confirm payment-provider & (later) government partnerships
- Kickoff within 1–2 weeks of sign-off

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Live demo

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